

# Global Development Lab (USA)

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# Overview of the Global Development Lab

- Established in 2014 by USAID
- Serves as the agency's innovation hub
- Designs and supports science-based and technology-driven development solutions
- Works globally across regions and sectors

# Mission & Strategic Goals

## **Missions**

- To accelerate development impact through the application of scientific research, digital tools, and innovative partnerships.

## **Strategic Goals:**

- Reduce extreme poverty
- Expand access to digital and technological solutions
- Promote sustainable, scalable innovations
- Build resilience in vulnerable communities

# Key Focus Areas

- Digital Development: Strengthening digital ecosystems and digital literacy
- Advanced Data & Analytics: Using data science, geospatial tools, and forecasting
- Science & Technology Research: Supporting new innovations for global health, agriculture, energy
- Innovation Financing: Blended finance, co-investment with private sector
- Partnerships & collaboration: connecting universities, NGOs, governments, and startups

# Major Programs & Achievements

- Grand challenges for Development: Global competitions that crowdsource solutions.
- Digital Finance Expansion: Supported mobile money and digital payment systems
- Health innovations: Low-cost medical tools, disease surveillance technologies.
- Agricultural Technology: Satellite-based crop monitoring, mobile advisory apps
- Humanitarian support: Data tools for crisis mappings and response

# Partnership & Global Impact

Key partners include:

- Universities (e.g. through Higher Education solutions Network)
- Private sector companies
- NGOs and civil society organizations
- International development agencies

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Global impact:

- Active in 60+ Countries
- Improved digital access for millions
- Strengthened local innovation ecosystems
- Enabled entrepreneurship and tech-enabled job creation

# Conclusion

- The Global Development Lab central to transforming U.S. foreign assistance through innovation.
- It integrates technology, science, partnerships, and data to solve global challenges.
- Continues to promote sustainable, scalable solutions in poverty reduction, digital development and global resilience.

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